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Democracy Dies in Darkness

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Trump foe James under Justice Dept. indictment

N.Y. attorney general is 2nd adversary charged by new prosecutor

BY PERRY STEIN, SALVADOR RIZZO AND JEREMY ROEBUCK

The Justice Department obtained an indictment against New York Attorney General Letitia James on Thursday, accusing her of committing mortgage fraud when she purchased a property in Virginia.

The indictment on one count of bank fraud and one of making a false statement makes James the second of President Donald Trump's political foes to be charged in the Eastern District of Virginia since Trump pushed out the top prosecutor there and appointed a close ally, Lindsey Halligan, to replace him. Halligan, who had no previous experience as a prosecutor, obtained an indictment two weeks ago against former FBI director James B. Comey on charges of making a false statement to Congress. He has pleaded not guilty.

SEE JAMES ON A4

In absence of federal data, economists are getting creative

BY ABHA BHATTARAI AND DAVID J. LYNCH

With the government closed and official data collection on hold, economists on Wall Street and beyond are scrambling to find new sources of information — or any clues, really — on what might be happening in the economy.

They're looking at paychecks, credit card expenditures, restaurant reservations, Broadway show bookings, and even Statue of Liberty visitor numbers. With so much of the economy in flux, anything might help, said Torsten Slok, chief economist at Apollo Global Management.

"We're suddenly opening up new spreadsheets, looking at data we don't usually turn to," Slok said. "Some of these

SEE DATA ON A15

Shutdown: Eight days in, GOP has yet to engage with Democrats. A3

Hostages' release, aid surge in works



HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST



HAITHAM IMAD/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Reactions Thursday to the Israel-Hamas ceasefire pact swept from Tel Aviv's "Hostages Square" — where, at top, Einav Zangauker, the mother of an Israeli captive, receives an embrace — to a celebratory scene in Khan Younis, in the Gaza Strip. Fresh Israeli strikes on Gaza City that same day and the deal's unresolved details underscored both its fragility and the hard diplomacy ahead of any lasting peace.

ISRAEL BACKS DEAL TO END WAR IN GAZA

Coming days seen as key for ceasefire with Hamas

BY CLAIRE PARKER, ABBIE CHEESEMAN, LIOR SOROKA AND KAREN DEYOUNG

SHARM EL-SHEIKH, EGYPT — Israeli ministers late Thursday approved an initial ceasefire with Hamas in Gaza, a deal intended to bring two years of devastating war to an end.

Cabinet approval sets in motion a sequence expected to bring about the release of some 48 Israeli hostages, living and dead, in exchange for hundreds of Palestinians held in Israeli prisons as well as a halt to Israel's bombardment of the Gaza Strip.

The ceasefire is to take effect within 24 hours of the vote, Israeli government spokeswoman Shosh Bedrosian said. During that window, Israeli forces are to withdraw from parts of Gaza — including most urban population centers — while retaining control of about half of the enclave. Humanitarian aid is to be surged to a population that has suffered hunger and deprivation.

Hamas and allied militants will then have 72 hours to hand over the remaining 20 hostages believed to be alive, as well as bodies of 28 deceased hostages, she said.

Celebrations broke out among Palestinians in Gaza and hostage

SEE DEAL ON A12

U.S. hardball with ally Israel cited as pivotal

BY MICHAEL BIRNBAUM, DAN DIAMOND AND KAREN DEYOUNG

President Donald Trump used "maximum pressure" against Israel over the past month to force it into a landmark ceasefire and hostage deal with Hamas, pushing hard on a close U.S. ally to end its war in Gaza after two years, a senior White House official said Thursday.

Although Trump didn't explicitly threaten Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu with a cutoff of weaponry if he did not halt the war, the relationship between an increasingly isolated Israel and its biggest military backer was clear to both leaders, the senior official said, after Netanyahu infuriated Trump and Arab partners with a September strike on Qatar, a close U.S. ally.

SEE TRUMP ON A12

A relentless ocean spawns a tempest in Outer Banks

Dozens of houses remain in peril of falling into the sea, with no easy answers in sight

BY BRADY DENNIS

When commissioners in Dare County, North Carolina, convened earlier this week, one topic dominated all others: the houses that keep collapsing into the sea on the Outer Banks, and those that might yet give way.

"Needless to say, the last several weeks we have really had some difficulties," said the board's chairman, Bob Woodard.

Last week alone, eight houses had fallen into the ocean — five of them in the span of a single hour — in the small Hatteras Island town of Buxton. Another had fallen in nearby Rodanthe, amid the swelling tides and churning Atlantic Ocean surf kicked up by offshore storms.



NATIONAL PARK SERVICE

A downed home in Rodanthe, North Carolina, on the Outer Banks. Storms have kicked up swells that are sweeping homes out to sea.

Recent days have seen a feverish sprint to clear and contain the devastation, a push that involved private landowners, volunteers and contractors with heavy machinery. Dozens of National Park Service employees helped collect 363 truckloads of debris off a stretch of the Cape Hatteras National Seashore, officials said, with still more to do.

"It's a major cleanup effort," said Dave Hallac, superintendent of the Cape Hatteras National Seashore.

But now, with that cleanup still incomplete and forecasters warning of more heavy rain, strong winds, fierce waves and coastal flooding that could lie ahead in coming days, local

SEE OUTER BANKS ON A7

Conservatives worry as they hear echoes of Francis in Leo

BY ANTHONY FAIOLA AND STEFANO PITRELLI

VATICAN CITY — Since the bells tolled in May for Pope Leo XIV, the first U.S.-born pontiff had largely guarded his words, appealing to all sides of a divided church. But in recent comments, as well as in his first major papal document issued Thursday, Leo has begun to reveal himself — leaving some conservative critics of his predecessor tut-tutting about the possible rise of another "liberal pope."

Leo's new document, an apostolic exhortation defending the poor and marginalized, is based on an unfinished text started by Pope Francis. In it, he quotes Francis, calling on the faithful to "welcome, protect, promote and inte-

grate" migrants. Leo takes aim at Christians who embrace "secular ideologies or political and economic approaches that lead to gross generalizations and mistaken conclusions." (He suggests they "go back and reread the Gospel.") And, deploying some of the same charged phrases favored by Francis, he pillories market capitalism, deriding "the dictatorship of an economy that kills" by enriching a small wealthy elite.

"Either we regain our moral and spiritual dignity," the document states, "or we fall into a cesspool."

The document's release follows the most vocal 10 days of Leo's pontificate. In rare off-the-cuff comments to the press, he chided

SEE POPE ON A11

IN THE NEWS

New targets in Ukraine Russia has expanded its attacks on energy infrastructure, striking natural gas facilities that are used to heat homes during the cold winter months. A8

A Halloween treat One Texas man spends all year thrifting, mending and redesigning thousands of free costumes for children. A2

THE NATION Videos are drawing unwanted attention to Katie Porter's campaign for California governor. A3

A Senate resolution to block strikes against alleged Venezuelan drug smugglers failed. A6

THE WORLD Trouble faces the E.U., as populism, protests and obstruction are on the march in the east. A9

Trump's decision to cut assistance to Africa has caused devastating medical shortages. A10

THE ECONOMY A test of Amazon's Prime Day prices found that they aren't always better, and in some cases could cost more. A14

The president's efforts to curb liberal speech have complicated the GOP campaign against tech firms' content moderation practices. A15

STYLE Online commentators have seized on lyrics from Taylor Swift's new album to suggest she is a secret conservative. B1

SPORTS The Wizards increased season ticket prices significantly, causing some longtime fans to walk away. B7

THE REGION Two students were suspended in Loudoun after an inquiry found they had harassed another student for months. B13

WEEKEND We went in search of the region's best pastrami on rye with a famous, and very opinionated, New York deli expert.

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